

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

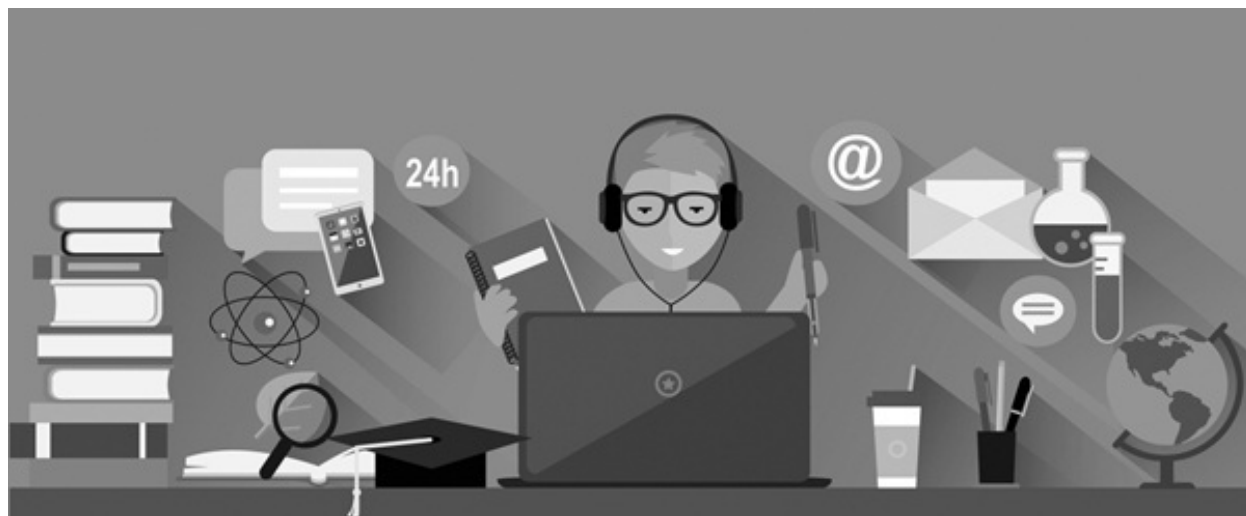
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Let's Start!

I'm taking a distance class on the Internet!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What types of classes do you think would be good to take on the Internet?
- What types of classes are better in a traditional classroom setting?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and personal dilemmas.
- I can express future actions.
- I can talk about unlikely situations using *if* or *whether*.

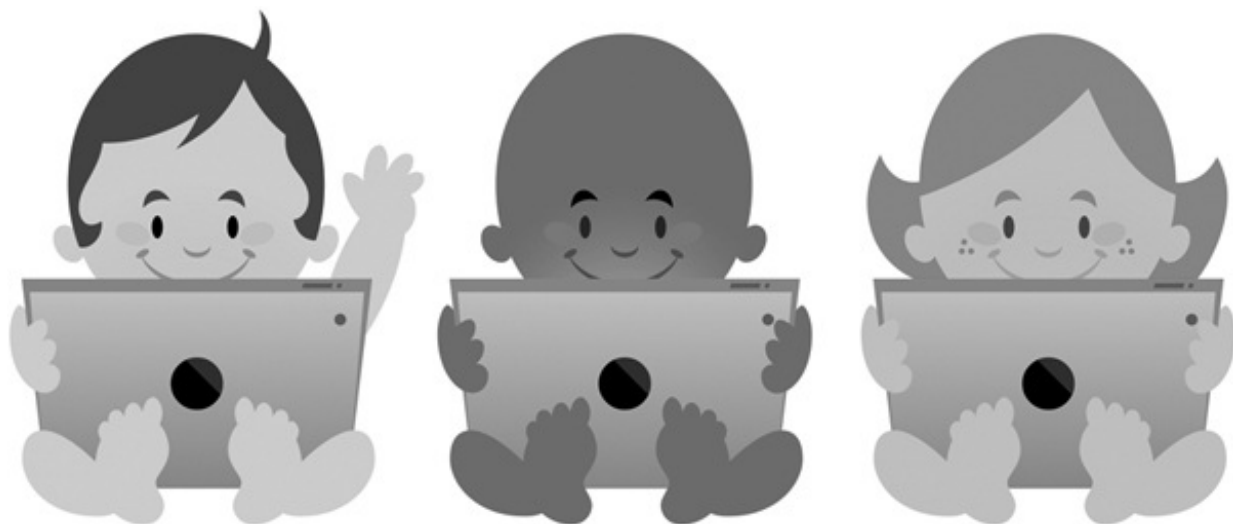




Let's Explore!

We were going to move into a **paperless*** future!

* A "paperless" office keeps all of its documents digital, printing out nothing.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I don't know whether or not you have considered how learning has changed in the digital age. Do you know whether people in your extended family had access to a computer when they were young?

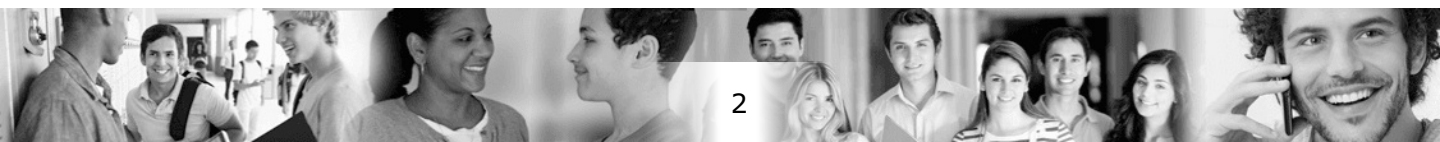
When I was confronted with moving into the digital age in the '90s I dove in headfirst. "Finally someone is going to keep all of my files for me! I'm not going to be up to my ears in papers I don't need. I'm inputting every old sheet I have in there, starting tomorrow! I'll be moving into the paperless future." Of course I was a little naive. Many people still didn't know whether this new technology would even survive to 2001. Ask someone to tell you that story!

Now, children are learning to type before they can speak. They are always going to be plugged into the magic screen whether you want them to be or not. When the latest model phone comes out they want it delivered to their hands.

In the world of education - especially higher education - the digital world has its perks. Students are going to find there is improved access to school and course information. Inquiries are faster. The application process is more streamlined. Students are choosing their courses in the summer, long before they arrive on campus in the fall. Some students will be participating in distance and online learning courses.

Does it matter if these courses are at home or abroad? It does not. I myself am picking courses at uni in Australia in the coming year.

Assignments and feedback are given out over the net whether you take a course online or in classrooms. The world of education travels the information highway these days. Do you?





Let's Practice!

Are you old enough to remember a time without the Internet?

Instructions: Fill in the gaps with the correct option. Read the sentences aloud. Compare yourself to a partner. Correct each other's pronunciation.

Word Bank

travels / has / are learning / surviving / was confronted

1. When I _____ with moving into the digital age in the '90s I dove in headfirst.
2. Now, children _____ to type before they can speak.
3. In the world of education - especially higher education - the digital world _____ its perks.
4. The world of education _____ the information highway these days.
5. Ask someone to tell you that story of the new technology _____ to 2001.



Let's Practice!

The question is: Did education get better with new technology?

Instructions: Match the halves to complete each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. I don't know whether or not you | a. whether this new technology would even survive to 2001. |
| 2. Do you know whether the people in your extended family | b. had access to a computer when they were young? |
| 3. Many people still didn't know | c. whether you want them to be or not. |
| 4. They are always going to be plugged into the magic screen | d. have considered how learning has changed in the digital age. |
| 5. Assignments and feedback are given out over the net | e. whether you take a course online or in classrooms. |





Extension Activity

Compare online courses and classroom courses.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Divide a paper in half and write down both the positive and not so positive aspects of taking a course in a traditional classroom setting or taking a course online.
- Come up with 5 or 6 ideas for each type of course.
- Write up a short presentation as if you were considering taking the same course online or in a classroom in the future.
- Present your ideas to a partner or group.
- Open a discussion on what you have presented.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I come up with 5 or 6 ideas on the positive and not so positive aspects of taking a course online or in a classroom.

☐ ☐

I prepare a short presentation.

☐ ☐

I use future tenses in my presentation.

☐ ☐

I use 'if' and/or 'whether' in my presentation.

☐ ☐

I open a discussion on my ideas.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- up to one's ears** (expression): having more than you can manage
e.g. I'm not going to be up to my ears in paper I don't need.
- to input** (verb): to enter
e.g. I'm inputting every old sheet I have in there, starting tomorrow!
- naïve** (adjective): innocently unaware
e.g. Of course I was a little naïve.
- to plug into** (verb): to be connected to, or know what is going on
e.g. They are always going to be plugged into the magic screen whether you want them to be or not.
- perk** (noun): advantage or benefit
e.g. The digital world has its perks.
- streamlined** (adjective): simpler and more effective
e.g. The application process is more streamlined.
- information highway** (noun): digital communication system
e.g. The world of education travels the information highway these days.





Learning Points

Talking About the Future

You use different tenses in the future to express different events or situations.

Be going to describes intentions or plans. At the moment of speaking the plans have already been made.

Example:

Finally someone is going to keep all of my files for me! I'm not going to be up to my ears in paper I don't need.

The **Present Continuous** describes fixed arrangements, especially social and travel arrangements. A time reference is usually included.

Example:

I'm inputting every old sheet I have in there, starting tomorrow!

The **Future Continuous** describes an event which will be happening at a future point.

Example:

Some students will be participating in distance and online learning courses.

Examples:

- *Students are going to find there is improved access to school and course information.*
- *Students are choosing their courses in the summer, long before they arrive on campus in the fall.*
- *I will be moving into the paperless future!*





Learning Points

If vs. Whether in the Unreal Conditional

You use the Unreal Conditional to talk about hypothetical situations and events, or outcomes that are unlikely to be true.

You use *if* or *whether* with the Unreal Conditional to say that the possible outcomes of a hypothetical condition have been thought about, or to suggest that you are unsure about something. They are usually interchangeable.

Example:

*Do you know **whether/if** the people in your extended family had access to a computer when they were young?*

Whether can be followed immediately by *or not*.

When you use *if*, ... *or not*, the *or not* is at the end of the sentence.

Example:

*I don't know **whether or not** you have considered the impact of the Internet on learning.*

*I don't know **if** you have considered the impact of the Internet **or not**.*

Examples:

- *I don't know whether or not you have considered how learning has changed in the digital age.*
- *Many people still didn't know whether this new technology would even survive to 2001.*
- *They are always going to be plugged into the magic screen whether you want them to be or not.*
- *Does it matter if these courses are at home or abroad?*
- *Assignments and feedback are given out over the net whether you take a course online or in classrooms.*

